> The evil of corruption has been spread by certain sections of society for their selfish interest. They have ignored the poor and cornered benefits. Some people have misused their office for personal gain.
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> There comes a time in the history of a country's development when a need is felt for a strong and decisive step. For years, this country has felt that corruption, black money, and terrorism are festering sores, holding us back in the race towards development.
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> To break the grip of corruption and black money, we have decided that the 500 rupee and 1,000 rupee currency notes presently in use will no longer be legal tender from midnight tonight, that is 8 November 2016. This means that these notes will not be acceptable for transactions from midnight onwards. The 500 and 1,000 rupee notes hoarded by anti-national and anti-social elements will become just worthless pieces of paper.

Summarizing the objectives of the move, the Prime Minister said, 'This step will strengthen the hands of the common man in the fight against corruption, black money and fake currency.' And in words reminiscent of former Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru, he added, 'In a country's history, there come moments when every person feels he too should be part of that moment, that he too should make his contribution to the country's progress. Such moments come but rarely…'

As people tried to weigh the implications of his message, phones across the country began ringing off the hook.

Many of India's high net worth individuals acted swiftly. Luxury malls sent messages to their regular customers that their doors would remain open till midnight. It is believed that more haute couture designer bags, shoes, clothes, watches and jewellery were sold in the next few hours than on any previous day in India. The stocks of many of these high value items were completely exhausted as people spent their money liberally before it turned 'worthless' the next morning.

At the other end of the spectrum, the poor worried about how they would convert the meagre cash they had into useable notes. As banks